4 QUALITY EDUCATION

Education for All

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A Work in pairs and complete the sentences.

1 The main reason I go to school is …

2 Adults want me to go to school because …

B Work in pairs and discuss the questions.

1 Why do you think education is important for everyone?

2 If you could change something about your education, what would you choose? Explain your ideas.

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A Read the information below and answer the questions.

1 Who agreed on the Global Goals and why?

2 What is the place given to education in the Global Goals?

Global Goals

In 2015, the United Nations agreed on a plan to eradicate poverty, ensure global growth and tackle climate change. This plan is called the **Sustainable Development Goals** (SDGs), or **Global Goals** for short. 193 countries all over the world agreed to work together to make this plan happen by the year 2030. Giving all children in the world quality education is one of the UN's Global Goals for 2030. Global Goal 4 aims to ensure quality education for all around the world.

B Make a list of reasons why a child might not be able to attend school. Compare your ideas with another student.

C Read the article. Does it mention your ideas from Ex 2B?

D Which of the barriers to education mentioned in the article do you think is the biggest problem? Explain why. Compare your ideas with another student.



BARRIERS TO EDUCATION

There are places in the world where children have little or no access to education. And there are categories of people, such as girls and children with disabilities, who find access to education difficult. However, increasing access to education can benefit the overall health and growth of a nation. Here are some of the issues that need to be addressed.

Qualified teachers

According to the United Nations, 69 million teachers are needed worldwide if we want to provide all children with universal primary and secondary education by 2030. What is more, the teachers and educators currently working in schools around the world need to be suitably qualified.

School buildings

There are places in the world where children can't go to school because their school has been destroyed by a war or a natural disaster. Conflicts and natural disasters destroy schools and cause severe problems for education systems. Globally, 75 million children have had their education disrupted by either a conflict or a natural disaster.

Facilities

Sometimes classes are overcrowded. There are schools which do not have essential facilities such as running water or toilets. Textbooks, school supplies and other learning materials are often missing or inadequate.

Disabled students

93 to 150 million children with disabilities are out of school in the world, i.e. they are denied their right to education.

Education of girls

The belief that there is less value in educating a girl than a boy is still widespread and difficult to eradicate. More than 130 million young girls globally do not regularly attend school. In less economically developed countries, over 30% of girls marry before the age 18 and leave school at that point.

Cost of education

Education has a cost for families. Even if school is free, there are costs for uniforms, school supplies and materials, and transportation. The expenses may be too high for a family on top of the money it loses when a child goes to school instead of working. That's why there are still places in the world where children are obliged to stay at home or find a job.

Government spending

Some governments spend very little on education. This results in education being less available and of lower quality.

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3 **Read the article again and answer the questions.**

1 What kinds of discrimination are mentioned in the article? Can you think of others?

2 How does climate change affect education?

3 How can poverty interfere with a child's education?

Language for citizenship

4 **Complete the text with the words/phrases in the box.**

be encouraged to go to school protect the environment respect children's rights be free respect other people's rights, cultures and differences develop their personalities, talents and abilities

The Rights of the Child
The UN's Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) is for children under the age of eighteen. Articles 28 and 29 of the Convention recognise education as a legal right of every child.

Article 28: Access to Education
Every child has the right to education. Primary education should [1]_____. Secondary and higher education should be available to every child. Children should [2]_____ to the highest level possible. Discipline in schools should [3]_____ and never use violence.

Article 29: Aims of Education
Children's education should help them fully [4]_____. It should teach them to understand their own rights and to [5]_____. It should help them to live peacefully and [6]_____.

CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

5 **Read Article 34 of the Italian Constitution. What are its key principles? Match the sentence halves.**

La scuola è aperta a tutti.
L'istruzione inferiore, impartita per almeno otto anni, è obbligatoria e gratuita.
I capaci e meritevoli, anche se privi di mezzi, hanno diritto di raggiungere i gradi più alti degli studi.
La Repubblica rende effettivo questo diritto con borse di studio, assegni alle famiglie ed altre provvidenze, che devono essere attribuite per concorso.

1 The right to education is
2 Compulsory education is
3 The Constitution indicates
4 Poverty can't
5 The state helps those who cannot

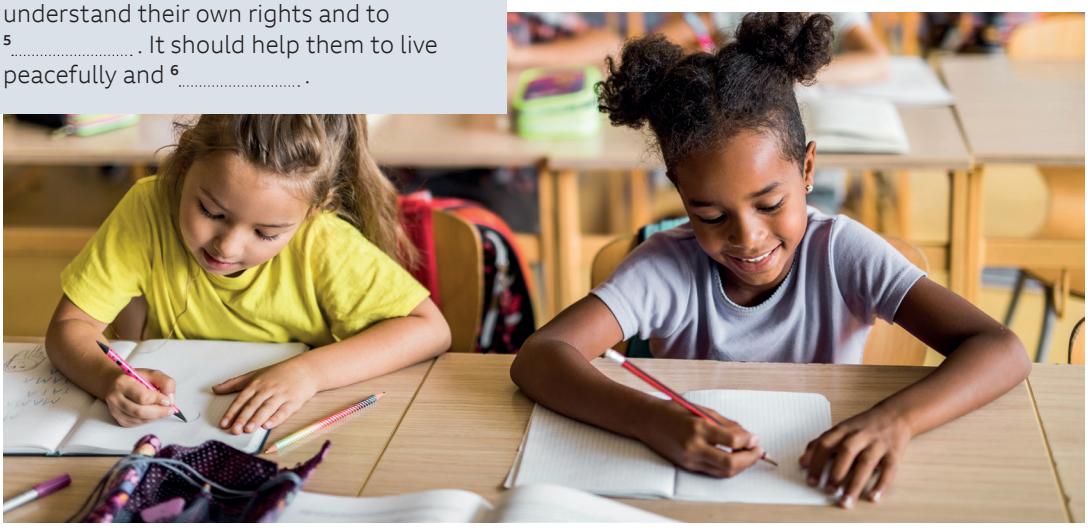
a afford to go to school.
b be an obstacle to a child's education.
c for everyone.
d a minimum number of eight years, but not a maximum number.
e free of charge.

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Digital literacies

6A **Think about possible barriers to quality education for all in your own community. Can you think of any initiatives you could take to improve the success of Global Goal 4 (Quality education) within your community? Go online and look for other ideas.**

B **Write a proposal (1–2 paragraphs) and be ready to discuss and support your ideas in class.**



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